MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-BVOC (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION April 2026

second SEMESTER

Skill Development Components (SDC) - MG2SDCBFT100 - VISUAL MERCHANDISING (2025 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Part A

Short Answer Questions Answer any 10 questions Each question carries 2 marks

1. How does colour influence customers in a retail store? [U] / [CO1]

Colour attracts attention, creates mood, and highlights products. Warm colours create excitement, while cool colours create a calm feeling and influence buying decisions.

2. Explain the importance of Proportion in retail display. [U] / [CO1]

Proportion refers to the relationship between sizes and spaces in a display. Proper proportion creates visual balance and makes the display attractive and comfortable to view.

3. How can festivals like Valentine's Day influence seasonal displays? [U] / [CO1]

Festivals help stores create special themed displays using suitable colours, props, and products. Valentine's Day displays usually use red and pink colours to attract customers and increase seasonal sales.

4. Define Line as an element of design in visual merchandising. [K] / [CO1]

Line is an element of design that gives direction and movement in a display. Lines may be vertical, horizontal, diagonal, curvy, or jagged.

5. How do interior displays differ from exterior displays? [U] / [CO2]

Interior displays are arranged inside the store to guide and encourage customers to buy products, while exterior displays attract customers from outside and create the first impression of the store.

6. What is exterior atmospherics? [K] / [CO2]

Exterior atmospherics refers to the physical environment outside the store, such as entrance, lighting, signage, parking, and display windows that influence customer attraction.

7. How does Related Merchandise Display help in increasing sales? [A] / [CO2]

Related merchandise display presents products that are used together. It encourages customers to buy additional items and increases overall sales.

8. What points should be considered while selecting a mannequin? [U] / [CO3, CO4]

The mannequin should match the target customers, be lightweight, clean, properly positioned, and suitable for the season and merchandise displayed.

9. What is the use of signage in a shop? [U] / [CO3, CO4]

Signage provides information, attracts attention, guides customers, promotes offers, and helps create the store's brand image.

10. Why is merchandising planning a continuous process? [An] / [CO3, CO4]

Merchandising planning is continuous because customer demand, fashion trends, and seasonal requirements change regularly and need constant updating.

11. What is inventory planning? [Ap] / [CO3, CO4]

Inventory planning is the process of deciding how much stock to keep, when to reorder, and how to avoid stock shortages or excess inventory.

12. What is a display shop? [U] / [CO3, CO4]

A display shop is a retail outlet where products are arranged attractively and systematically to attract customers and increase sales.

[2x10 = 20]

Part B

Short Essay Questions Answer any 6 questions Each question carries 5 marks

13. What is a "target customer" in visual merchandising? [K] / [CO1]

A target customer is the specific group of customers a store wants to attract and sell products to. They are identified based on age, gender, income, lifestyle, and buying behaviour. Visual merchandisers design store displays, colours, lighting, and themes according to the preferences of the target customers. For example, a youth fashion store uses trendy colours and modern displays to attract young buyers. Understanding target customers helps improve sales and customer satisfaction.

14. How does visual merchandising increase sales and improve store image? [U] / [CO1]

Visual merchandising attracts customers through attractive displays, lighting, colours, and store arrangements. It improves product visibility and encourages impulse buying. Proper visual merchandising creates a pleasant shopping atmosphere and helps customers understand product features. It also strengthens brand identity and improves the store image. Attractive window displays and organized interiors encourage customers to enter the store and make purchases.

15. What role do window displays play in shaping a store's image? [U] / [CO2]

Window displays are the first point of communication between the store and customers. They attract attention and create curiosity about the products inside. Effective window

displays communicate the brand image, seasonal themes, and fashion trends. They help convert passers-by into customers. Attractive displays also create a strong visual identity and improve the store's reputation.

16. Evaluate the effectiveness of shadow boxes and showroom/boutique displays in promoting merchandise. [E] / [CO2]

Shadow boxes are small display windows used to highlight special or valuable products like jewellery and accessories. They attract attention through focused lighting and close-up presentation. Showroom and boutique displays create a lifestyle presentation and help customers visualize fashion trends. These displays create emotional appeal and improve customer interest. Both methods effectively increase product visibility and sales.

17. Explain how mannequins help in attracting customers into the store. [E] / [CO3, CO4]

Mannequins act as silent salespersons by displaying garments attractively. They show customers how clothes look when worn and help present fashion trends and styling ideas. Mannequins attract attention from outside the store and encourage customers to enter. They also help in upselling by displaying matching accessories and coordinated outfits. Attractive mannequins improve the visual appeal of the store.

18. Explain the different types of mannequins used in retail stores. [E] / [CO3, CO4]

1. **Realistic Mannequins** – Natural looking mannequins with realistic facial features.
2. **Semi-realistic Mannequins** – Stylized mannequins with decorative makeup.
3. **Abstract Mannequins** – Simplified mannequins without realistic details.
4. **Semi-abstract Mannequins** – Combination of realistic and abstract features.
5. **Headless Mannequins** – Full body mannequins without heads, mainly used for garment focus. Each type is selected according to store theme and target customers.

19. Describe the different types of store layouts used in retail stores. [U] / [CO3, CO4]

Grid Layout

Straight aisles arranged in rows, commonly used in supermarkets.

Racetrack Layout

Circular pathway guiding customers through the entire store.

Free-flow Layout

Flexible arrangement allowing creative product placement, common in fashion stores.

Boutique Layout

Small sections arranged for different product categories, creating an exclusive shopping experience.

Proper store layout improves customer movement and product visibility.

20. Explain how merchandising planning supports seasonal themes and promotional layouts. [U] / [CO3, CO4]

Merchandising planning ensures that the right products are available during seasonal events and promotions. It helps visual merchandisers arrange products according to themes such as Christmas, Valentine's Day, or festival sales. Proper planning supports attractive displays, avoids stock shortages, and improves coordination between buyers and visual merchandisers. This increases customer interest and sales.

21. Why is availability of merchandise important for visual displays? [U] / [CO3, CO4]

Availability of merchandise is essential because attractive displays are effective only when products are in stock. Customers may lose interest if displayed items are unavailable. Proper stock availability supports seasonal displays, promotional themes, and customer satisfaction. It also helps maintain the store image and increases sales opportunities.

[5x6 = 30]

Part C

Essay Questions

Answer any 2 questions Each question carries 10 marks

22. How do visual merchandising strategies, like seasonal or promotional displays, strengthen a store's image? [E] / [CO1]

Visual merchandising is the art of presenting products attractively to increase sales and improve store image. Seasonal and promotional displays are important visual merchandising strategies that help attract customers and strengthen brand identity.

Seasonal Displays-Seasonal displays are arranged according to seasons and festivals such as Christmas, Valentine's Day, Onam, or summer sales. These displays use suitable colours, props, lighting, and merchandise to create excitement among customers. Seasonal themes make the store look fresh and attractive.

Promotional Displays

Promotional displays highlight special offers, discounts, or new arrivals. These displays attract customer attention and encourage impulse buying. Promotional signage and creative arrangements help communicate marketing messages effectively.

Strengthening Store Image

1. Creates attractive and memorable shopping experience
2. Builds strong brand identity
3. Communicates fashion trends and themes
4. Improves customer satisfaction
5. Increases customer traffic and sales
6. Differentiates the store from competitors

23. Evaluate how effective window displays create store image, build brand identity, and influence customer buying behaviour. [E] / [CO2]

Window displays are considered the “face” or “visiting card” of a store. They are one of the most powerful tools in visual merchandising.

Creating Store Image

Window displays create the first impression of the store. Attractive displays communicate the quality, style, and personality of the brand. Customers judge the store based on the appearance of the windows.

Building Brand Identity

Window displays help communicate brand themes, colours, and fashion trends consistently. Luxury brands use elegant displays, while youth brands use colourful and trendy arrangements. This strengthens brand recognition.

Influencing Buying Behaviour

1. Attracts passers-by into the store
2. Creates curiosity and interest
3. Highlights featured products and promotions
4. Encourages impulse buying
5. Helps customers visualize product usage

Importance of Lighting and Theme

Proper lighting, colour combinations, mannequins, props, and signage increase the effectiveness of window displays.

24. Discuss in detail the importance of mannequins in retail stores,including their role as silent salespersons, group display usage, and the need for periodic change.[U] / [CO3, CO4]

Mannequins are one of the most important tools in visual merchandising. They help display garments attractively and communicate fashion trends to customers.

Role as Silent Salespersons

Mannequins are called silent salespersons because they promote products without speaking. They show customers how garments fit and appear when worn. Customers can easily visualize styles, colours, and combinations.

Attracting Customers

Mannequins placed in windows and interiors attract attention and encourage customers to enter the store. They improve the visual appeal of displays.

Group Display Usage

Stores often use mannequins in groups to present coordinated fashion collections. Group displays strengthen fashion themes and create realistic lifestyle presentations.

Upselling and Styling

Mannequins help in upselling by displaying matching accessories such as bags, shoes, and jewellery along with garments.

Need for Periodic Change

Mannequins and clothing displays should be changed regularly to avoid monotony and maintain customer interest. Seasonal and promotional updates keep the store fresh and attractive.

Types of Mannequins

- Realistic
- Semi-realistic
- Abstract
- Semi-abstract
- Headless mannequins

25. Explain the planning process before setting up a display shop and discuss the role of customer analysis, product selection, budget, and theme planning. [K] / [CO3, CO4]

A display shop is a retail outlet where products are arranged attractively to attract customers and increase sales. Proper planning is necessary before setting up a display shop.

Planning Process

1. Target Customer Analysis

The retailer studies customer age, income, lifestyle, and buying behaviour. Understanding customers helps create suitable store design and displays.

2. Product Selection

Products should match customer demand and store theme. Proper product selection improves sales opportunities.

3. Budget Planning

Budget planning includes estimating expenses for lighting, fixtures, mannequins, signage, props, and interiors. Proper budgeting avoids unnecessary spending.

4. Theme Planning

Themes may be seasonal, festive, or promotional. Themes help create attractive visual presentations and improve customer interest.

Steps in Setting Up a Display Shop

1. Store layout planning
2. Fixture and furniture selection
3. Lighting arrangement
4. Colour and theme application
5. Signage and graphics arrangement

Importance of Proper Planning

- Improves store image
- Enhances customer experience
- Increases sales and profitability
- Encourages impulse buying
- Ensures better space utilization

[10x2 =20]